



HEURISTIC EVALUATION

Antz Onboarding web experience

The current build, measured against Nielsen's ten usability heuristics, with suggestions and recommendations for what to change next.

Date

25 September 2026

Build

Local, antz-onboard/

Audience

Prospective clients

Findings

24 (6 major)

A polished tour whose content now lags behind its craft

Verdict

The interaction model is strong. Module cards open in place, the preview follows the visitor's tap on phones, Back restores their place, and every animation respects reduced motion. Most of the remaining problems are about what the page says and shows rather than how it behaves. Placeholder icons and two repeated photos make 32 modules look alike. Some screens are not the product. The staff-training copy speaks to the wrong reader. The one conversion path still depends on an email link. The motion layer has also grown to seven separate effects, which is more than a first-time visitor needs.

Findings by heuristic

HEURISTIC	3	2	1	HEALTH
1 · Visibility	1	2	0	
2 · Real-world match	3	0	1	
3 · Control, freedom	0	1	1	
4 · Consistency	1	2	1	
5 · Error prevention	1	0	0	
6 · Recognition	0	2	1	
7 · Efficiency	0	1	2	
8 · Minimalism	0	2	0	
9 · Error recovery	0	0	1	
10 · Help, docs	0	1	0	

Columns count findings at each severity. No catastrophic (4) issues were found.

Recommended first moves

- Give every card its own identity.** Replace placeholder icons and the two repeated photos with module-specific imagery. (H2.1, H6.1)
- Show only the real product.** Swap the Deworming screen and remove stock photos from device frames. (H2.3)
- Rewrite the three kit sections for prospects.** Drop "training", "kit" and "Module 03". (H2.2)
- Give booking a real destination** with a confirmation state. (H5.1)
- Fix the action-green contrast** and the module-page tour on phones. (H4.1, H1.1)

6

Major (3)

11

Minor (2)

7

Cosmetic (1)

What is working well

Explore in place.

Cards open a panel under their own row, so the grid never jumps and the visitor never loses context.

The preview follows the tap.

On phones the screen appears under the selected feature, which fixes the most serious issue in the September audit.

State is kept.

Back from a module restores the open card and exact scroll position. The logo resets cleanly.

Keyboard-friendly.

Esc closes and returns focus to the card, arrow keys step through features, and chips and cards show the drawn border on focus.

Motion is considerate.

Every effect switches off under reduced motion, and the card entrance is a quiet 12px fade-up.

A real brand signature.

The green-to-teal drawn border ties cards, chips and panels into one recognisable system.

METHOD

How the evaluation was done

An expert review of the live local build, walking five prospect tasks at 1440px and 390px in Chrome 153, and checking each screen against Nielsen's ten heuristics.

Tasks walked

- Understand what Antz is from the first screen
- Find how Antz handles a vaccination, and see the screen
- Compare two modules in the same area
- Decide whether Antz fits a multi-site organisation
- Book a walkthrough

Severity scale (Nielsen)

4 CATASTROPHIC	Must fix before release
3 MAJOR	Important to fix, high priority
2 MINOR	Fix, lower priority
1 COSMETIC	Fix if time allows

Limits

- One evaluator. Heuristic reviews by a single person typically find around a third of usability problems, so a short test with prospects (see Validate) should follow.
- Screen readers were not tested live. Timings were measured in the browser; page weight is from the network log (2.9 MB after a full tour).
- The shared artifact link is an older version and was not evaluated.

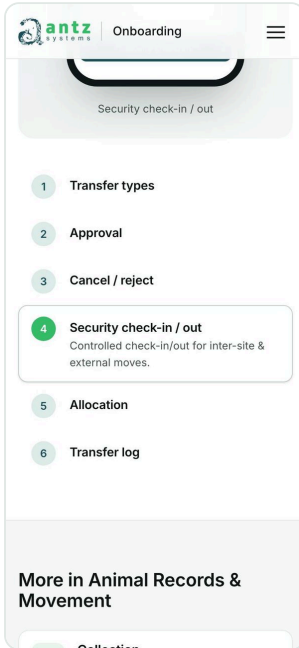
24 findings across the ten heuristics

H1 Visibility of system status

Does the page show what is happening?

H1.1 On a phone, the module page tour still changes a screen that is out of view

3 MAJOR



Step 4 selected; only the caption above is visible.

SEEN

The card panels were fixed to show the screen under the tapped feature. The full module pages (#/m/...), which search results and "Open the full tour" lead to, still place the device above the list.

WHY

The same action gives visible feedback in one view and none in the other. Search sends prospects straight into the broken one.

FIX

Reuse the panel's inline-preview behaviour on module pages at 900px and below.

H1.2 Card rows below the fold are invisible until scrolled to

2 MINOR

SEEN

Each area's cards start at zero opacity and fade up when the group enters the viewport. Link previews, thumbnails and full-page captures show empty gaps, and fast scrolling can outrun the reveal.

FIX

Render cards visible by default and only apply the fade when a group is about to enter view (add the hidden state just before, not on load).

H1.3 The rotating search suggestion never pauses and cannot be used

2 MINOR

SEEN

It changes every 2.4 seconds for as long as the page is open. Pressing Enter on "Search Housing" does nothing because the field is empty.

FIX

Pause after three cycles and on hover (WCAG 2.2.2). Let Enter or Tab accept the current suggestion.

H2.1Placeholder icons tell the wrong story3 MAJOR

Operations & Oversight10

Animal Records & Movement7 modules



Collection

Manage and document every aspect of an institution's animal collection...

3 features



Housing

Organize animal habitats across your sites, sections and enclosures...

3 features



Animal Management

Bring all animal records together in one place

6 features



Tags Hub

Helps you organize and categorize different entries (sites, sections,...

6 features

SEEN

16 of 32 cards use an icon picked from the set as a stand-in. Icons are read before titles, so each mismatch plants a wrong idea about the module.

FIX

Until the real icons exist, show the area's icon (paw, cross, egg, report) on cards without their own. It is generic but never wrong.

H2.2The kit sections speak to trainees, not prospects3 MAJOR



WHY WE RUN THIS TRAINING

Objective of this kit

Onboarding has four jobs: get every team member confident in their day-to-day activities, get the platform adopted across roles, identify gaps so we can improve, and standardize how records are kept across sites.



Skill development

Enhance staff knowledge and the practical skills needed for effective zoo operations, animal care, and confident use of the Antz platform.



System adoption

Familiarize users with every app module and build confidence to perform the core actions like recording, reviewing and approving without supervision.



Continuous improvement

Identify the gaps, clarify the doubts, and use feedback-driven learning to refine workflows and module behaviour over time.



Standardisation

Consistent protocols across teams and sites, same module behaviour for Requests, Mortality, Eggs and Chet so every record reads the same way.

SEEN

"Why we run this training", "Objective of this kit", "Module 03 · Onboarding flow", the header label "Onboarding", and copy such as "get every team member confident" and "build confidence without supervision".

WHY

A buyer is not yet on a training course. The words signal an internal document and weaken the pitch.

FIX

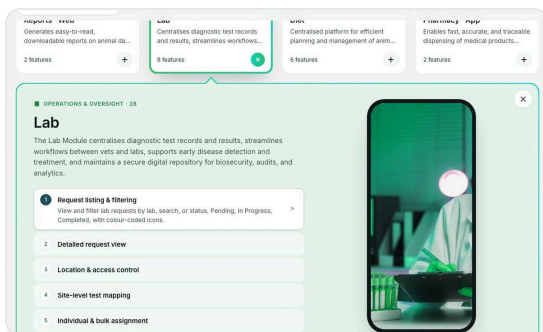
Reframe as outcomes: "What your team gets", "How rollout works". Rename the header label to "Product tour".

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H2.3 Some "screens" are not the product

3 MAJOR



SEEN

Lab, Diet, Pharmacy · Web and Compliance show a stock photo framed as an app screen. Deworming shows Vaccination's menu, titled "Vaccination".

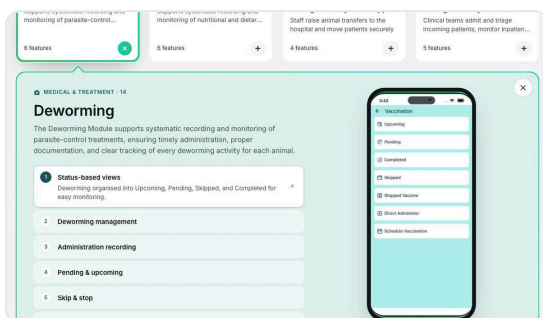
WHY

The panels are the kit's proof. A vet or compliance lead will notice, and it undermines every other screen.

FIX

Replace the Deworming capture. For modules without captures, drop the device and show feature cards with the photo as a header, marked "Screens coming soon".

Lab: a stock photo inside the phone frame.



Deworming: the phone shows the Vaccination screen.

H2.4 Names and summaries follow the system, not the reader

1 COSMETIC

SEEN "Notes Module", "Helpdesk Module", "Hospital Information Management System · App". Summaries are auto-trimmed intros and end mid-sentence.

FIX Drop "Module", shorten HIMS to "Hospital", and write a 12-word tagline per module.

H3 User control and freedom

Can people undo, leave and share?

H3.1 An open card cannot be shared or bookmarked

2 MINOR

SEEN The open panel is page state only. Copying the URL shares the top of the home page. The only shareable deep link is the separate module page.

FIX Reflect the open card in the hash (#housing) and reopen it on load, scrolled into view.

H3.2 Closing waits for the animation

1 COSMETIC

SEEN X or Esc un-draws the border (0.55 s) before the panel fades (0.28 s). The panel is unclickable meanwhile, so a quick close-then-reopen feels sluggish.

FIX Run the un-draw and fade together, total under 0.35 s. Opening can stay slow and lovely; closing should be quick.

H4.1 The action green fails WCAG contrast

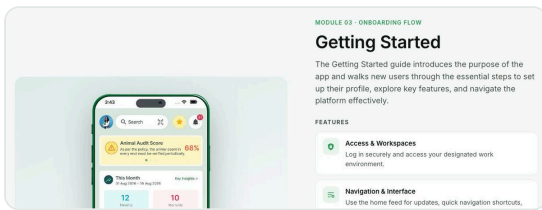
3 MAJOR

SEEN White on #37BD69 is 2.43:1 on every "Book a walkthrough" and "Open the full tour" button, against a 4.5:1 minimum. Green eyebrows (#2A9D55) are 3.47:1.

FIX Use #27864B (4.57:1) for button fills and green text; keep #37BD69 and the gradient for borders and accents, where 3:1 is enough.

H4.2 Numbers contradict each other

2 MINOR

**SEEN**

Cards are numbered 01 to 32, where 03 is Collection, yet the Getting Started section is labelled "Module 03". The "All 32" chip prints the total the team agreed not to quote until the module count is settled.

FIX

Remove card numbers (they carry no meaning for prospects), drop "Module 03", and show "All" without a count until the module count is settled.

H4.3 Two different views for the same module

2 MINOR

SEEN The in-place panel and the full module page present the same content with different layouts, behaviours and phone handling.

FIX Make the module page render the panel component at full width, so there is one pattern to learn and maintain.

H4.4 Hero chips and filter chips look unrelated

1 COSMETIC

SEEN The hero uses spaced capitals on glass; the filters use sentence case pills with counts. Both mean the same five areas.

FIX Use sentence case and the same pill shape in both places.

H5.1 Booking can fail without the visitor knowing

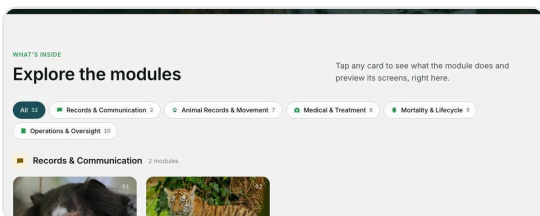
3 MAJOR

- SEEN** All three "Book a walkthrough" buttons open a `mailto:` link. On a work laptop with no mail app, or inside a shared page, nothing happens. The address is shown as text only in the bottom banner.
- FIX** Link to a short form or scheduler with a confirmation state. Until then, show the address with a copy button beside every booking button.

H6 Recognition rather than recall

H6.1 32 cards share two photos

2 MINOR



- SEEN** Every card alternates the marmoset and the tiger cub. The earlier thumbnails showed each module's screen; now only the title distinguishes one card from the next, and the summary is cut at two lines.
- FIX** Commission one photo per area (five images) so the grid is readable by colour and subject, and let the icon carry the module.

H6.2 Search lives only in the hero

2 MINOR

- SEEN** Once a visitor scrolls past the banner or opens a module page, the only way to find something is to scroll or go back.
- FIX** Add a compact search to the sticky header (opened with `/`), with synonyms such as "death" for Mortality and "hospital" for HIMS.

H6.3 Filters wrap to a lonely second row

1 COSMETIC

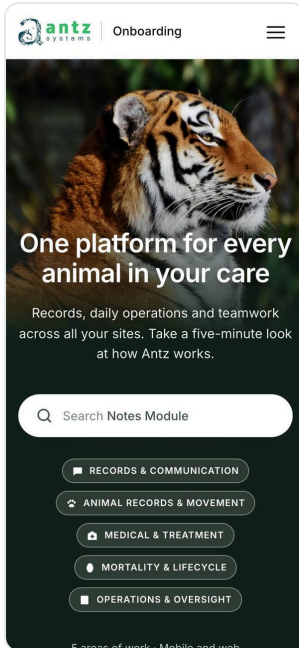
- SEEN** At 1440px "Operations & Oversight" drops to a row of its own, which makes it look secondary.
- FIX** Shorten labels (Records, Animals, Medical, Lifecycle, Operations) so all six fit on one row.

H7 Flexibility and efficiency of use

Is it quick for someone in a hurry?

H7.1 The page is very long

2 MINOR



SEEN

11,600px on desktop, most of it the 32-card grid. On a phone the hero alone fills the first screen, with five stacked chips at 32px (under the 44px touch target).

FIX

Show one row per area with "Show all 7", and put the phone chips in one scrolling row at 44px.

H7.2 Features cannot be scanned all at once

1 COSMETIC

SEEN

Only the selected feature shows its description, and each selection replays a one-second device rise.

FIX

Add a "Show all descriptions" toggle, and play the rise only on the first view per panel.

H7.3 Touch visitors miss the signature effect

1 COSMETIC

SEEN

The drawn border and lift are hover effects. On phones a card simply opens.

FIX

Play the border draw on tap-and-hold or on open (it already runs on open), and add a subtle press state.

H8 Aesthetic and minimalist design

Is anything competing for attention?

H8.1 Seven motion effects compete

2 MINOR

SEEN

Hero parallax, card fade-up, card border draw, chip border draw, chip lift and wash, panel border draw, and a device rise on every feature. Individually tasteful; together they make the page feel busy.

FIX

Keep the gradient border as the one signature. Retire the chip border draw (the wash is enough), and limit the device rise to first view.

H8.2 Twenty cards in three sections

2 MINOR

- | | |
|------|---|
| SEEN | Objective (4 cards), What is Antz (6 cards), Getting Started (6 list items) and the stepper (4 steps) all use the same white-card treatment in a row. |
| FIX | Merge Objective into What is Antz as three outcomes, and fold Getting Started's six features into the four-step stepper. |

H9 Help users recognise, diagnose and recover from errors

H9.1 Unknown links fail silently

1 COSMETIC

- | | |
|------|--|
| SEEN | A mistyped or retired module link redirects to the top of the home page without explanation. The search empty state, by contrast, is good: it names the query and suggests alternatives. |
| FIX | Show a short "That module has moved" note above the cards, with the closest match. |

H10 Help and documentation

H10.1 The FAQ skips the buyer's first questions

2 MINOR

- | | |
|------|--|
| SEEN | Five answers cover devices, roles and sites. Nothing on pricing, time to go live, migrating existing records, training, offline use or where data is hosted. |
| FIX | Ask sales for the ten most common questions and add approved answers, grouped as Product, Rollout and Security. |

Suggestions beyond the fixes

These go further than individual findings. Each one makes the tour easier to follow or more memorable without adding weight.

1. Lead with one story

Open the page, after the banner, with a single scenario that crosses modules: "Moving an animal between sites" through Transfer, Approvals, Security and Housing. Real screens exist for every step.

Prospects remember stories, not catalogues. The grid then becomes the reference.

2. Choose your role

Four small cards (Curator, Vet, Keeper, Director) that filter the grid to the six modules each role uses daily.

Turns 32 choices into six, in the visitor's own terms.

3. One module, two surfaces

Merge each App and Web pair, and the three treatment modules, behind an App | Web switch inside the panel.

Takes the grid from 32 cards to about 24 and shows the two-surface story visually.

4. A proof strip

Under the banner: number of sites, animals and species managed on Antz, and one customer quote. Only real figures from Antz.

The page currently has claims but no evidence.

5. Photography with a job

One graded photo per area, subjects looking into the page, with space for the icon. Reuse the same five across hero chips, filters and cards.

Colour and subject become navigation cues.

6. A motion budget

Write it down: one signature (the gradient border), one entrance (the fade-up), and quick exits. Anything new has to replace something.

Keeps the craft visible without the page feeling busy.

Roadmap

Now

About 2 days · before sharing

- Area icons in place of placeholders H2.1
- Deworming screen, no stock photos in frames H2.3
- Action-green token H4.1
- Booking form or copyable address H5.1
- Module-page tour on phones H1.1
- Remove card numbers and "All 32" H4.2

Next

1 to 2 weeks

- Prospect copy for the kit sections H2.2
- Shareable open cards H3.1
- Header search H6.2
- One row per area, "Show all" H7.1
- Motion budget, quick close H8.1 H3.2
- Merge the kit sections H8.2
- Visible-by-default cards, pausing search hint H1.2 H1.3

Later

Needs content from Antz

- Real module icons
- Five area photos H6.1
- Cross-module scenario
- Role paths
- Proof strip
- Buyer FAQ H10.1

VALIDATE

Test it with five prospects

Twenty-minute remote sessions, thinking aloud, after the "Now" fixes. Track success, time on task, and a 1 to 7 ease rating.

#	TASK	WHAT IT CHECKS
1	"You manage three sites. Can Antz handle moving an animal between them?"	Finding a module, panel comprehension
2	"Show me what recording a vaccination looks like." (on a phone)	Search, module page on mobile
3	"Which two modules would your vets use most? Why?"	Card recognition, icons, copy
4	"Send a colleague a link to the Housing module."	Shareable state
5	"Arrange a demo for your team."	Conversion path

APPENDIX

Progress since the September audit

AUDIT	ISSUE	STATUS	NOTE
F1	Mobile tour shows screen out of view	Partly fixed	Fixed in card panels; open on module pages (H1.1)
F2	Stock photos in phone frames	Open	H2.3
F3	Featured workflow opens on a dimmed screen	Open	Animal Transfer step 1 still shows the modal
F5	Duplicate modules, wrong Deworming screen	Open	H2.3, recommendation 3
F6	Area tabs hid most of the catalogue	Fixed	Replaced by grouped cards with an All filter
F7	Card copy written for training	Partly fixed	"The X Module" openings removed; still cut mid-sentence (H2.4)
F8	Search only on home; Back loses place	Partly fixed	Back now restores place; search still hero-only (H6.2)
F10	Phone hero fills the first screen	Open	H7.1
F11	Rotating placeholder never stops	Open	H1.3
F12	Booking is only an email link	Partly fixed	Address shown in the banner; buttons still mailto (H5.1)
F14	FAQ misses buyer questions	Open	H10.1
F15	Brand green fails contrast	Open	H4.1
F16	Screen reader and focus handling	Partly fixed	Esc returns focus, panels are labelled regions; route changes still silent
F17	Heavy screenshots	Partly fixed	784 KB of card thumbnails; full screens still up to 1.9 MB
F19	Mixed icon styles	Partly fixed	Brand icons on cards; UI icons still mixed